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SCENARIO 2 ...**



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AI Reflection Coach



TEACHING & RESEARCH DESIGN

SCENARIO 2 - GLOBAL TEAM, SHIFTING REQUIREMENTS

THE STORY

LearnLoop is a startup that just raised 3.2M EUR to build an AI-powered adaptive learning platform for universities. 12 people, three cities, very different skill sets:

Amsterdam (UTC+1) – 4 people:

Product managers, UX designers, 1 frontend developer

Strength: user research, product vision, GDPR knowledge

Weakness: no ML or backend expertise

Bangalore (UTC+5:30) - 5 people:

Backend engineers, ML engineers, 1 DevOps engineer

Strength: recommendation systems, scalable infrastructure

Weakness: no direct contact with end users or customers

Austin (UTC-6) - 3 people:

Business development, data analyst, customer success

Strength: weekly calls with the pilot customer (University of Texas)

Weakness: no technical or product background

Timezone reality:

Amsterdam ↔ Bangalore: 4.5h gap - small morning overlap only

Amsterdam ↔ Austin: 7h gap - small evening overlap only

Bangalore ↔ Austin: 11.5h gap - nearly zero overlap

The first pilot customer wants a working MVP (Minimum Viable Product) in 9 months.

After the first stakeholder workshops, three problems surface immediately:

Nobody at the university agrees on what the platform should do.

IT wants LMS integration. Professors want content control.

Students want to see why a re

Legal wants FERPA (Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act)

compliance before any student data is processed.

Austin collects new requirements every week in customer calls,

but there is no process to pass them to Amsterdam or Bangalore.

Bangalore has already started building the recommendation engine -

but Amsterdam has not yet decided.

Two engineers are frustrated

that are architecturally important.

The CEO is optimistic. The team is not.

TASK 1 - ANALYSE

Which Scrum elements create specific problems here? (Bullets points are fine)

Scrum Element

Still works?

Why / Why not?

2 – week sprints

Definition of Done

Backlog prioritization

Sprint Review Demo

Velocity tracking

TASK 2 - DECIDE

Three situations. For each: pick one option and justify your choice.

"We would do both" is not an answer.

SITUATION A - WHOSE DESIGN WINS?

Amsterdam has designed a user interface that requires real-time

personalisation data streamed from the backend.

Bangalore says this is technically impossible with the current

architecture - a full redesign would take 3 months.

You have 9 months until the MVP deadline.

You cannot do a 3-month redesign AND build all features in time.

You have three options:

- (1) Amsterdam adapts the design to the new requirements.
Risk: the user experience becomes inconsistent.
- (2) Bangalore does the redesign. Spreads the redesign over 9 months, making it visible, putting the 9-month deadline at risk.
- (3) Ship the MVP with the weaker UX, then iterate after the pilot customer has seen the product.

Which do you choose?

Who has the authority to make this call - and what happens if

Amsterdam and Bangalore cannot agree?

SITUATION B - THE ONLY MEETING SLOT

You have exactly one 90-minute slot per week where all three teams

can meet synchronously (15:00-16:30 Amsterdam time).

This week you have three agenda items that are all critical:

- (1) Finalise the data model - Bangalore
- (2) Review 6 new requirements from the pilot customer - Amsterdam
- (3) Make a decision before the next customer meeting - Bangalore

(3) Resolve the Amsterdam/Bangalore
from Situation A - it has been

You can cover two of the three properly in 90 minutes.

Which item do you drop from the live meeting?

How do you handle it differently so it does not stall the team?

SITUATION C - THE LEGAL BLOCKER

Halfway through Sprint 3, Austin calls with urgent news:

the University of Texas legal team has blocked all student data

collection until a FERPA (Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act)

compliance agreement is signed. Signing takes 6-8 weeks minimum.

Bangalore is currently mid-sprint, building the recommendation engine

that depends entirely on that student data.

You have three options:

(1) Stop Bangalore's work immediate

Cost: 6-8 weeks of lost develop

(2) Continue building the engine on

Risk: the engine may need signi

and behaves differently than ex

(3) Redirect Bangalore to a differe

(e.g., the LMS integration) whi

Risk: context switching costs a

Which option do you choose?

How do you communicate this decision to the Bangalore team?

TASK 3 - REFLECT

In 2-3 sentences:

Which situation revealed the biggest structural weakness in how LearnLoop is organised?

What would need to change in the company to make that situation not happen in the first place?

EXTRA TASK – RATE

Rate the reflexionbot in 2-3sentences:



TASK 1 - ANALYSE

Scrum Element	Still works?	Why / Why not?
2-week sprints	No	The differing time zones and misalignment of priorities lead to incomplete work and lack of consistent progress.
Definition of Done	No	Without consensus on deliverables from all stakeholders, what

Scrum Element	Still works?	Why / Why not?
		defines "done" becomes subjective and inconsistent across teams.
Backlog prioritization	No	There is no unified process to prioritize and manage the backlog across all teams, leading to miscommunication and misalignment.
Sprint Review Demo	No	The lack of agreement on requirements means that demonstration of completed work is ineffective and can cause further confusion.
Velocity tracking	No	Without clear alignment on what is being developed, velocity becomes an unreliable metric, making it difficult to predict future sprints.

TASK 2 - DECIDE

SITUATION A - WHOSE DESIGN WINS?

I choose option (3) — ship the MVP with the

weaker UX first, then redesign after the pilot customer has seen it. This approach allows for a quicker release while gathering valuable user feedback, which can inform future design improvements. The product owner or CEO typically has the authority to make this decision. If Amsterdam and Bangalore cannot agree, it may lead to delays and escalate conflicts, necessitating a mediation process or escalation to higher management.

SITUATION B - THE ONLY MEETING SLOT

I would drop agenda item (3) to resolve the architecture conflict. Instead, I would handle it asynchronously by assigning a small sub-team to clarify the architectural requirements and report back. This could prevent stalling and ensure that Bangalore can still progress on the technical side while conflicts are resolved outside the meeting.

SITUATION C - THE LEGAL BLOCKER

I choose option (3) — redirect Bangalore to a different part of the product while legal issues are resolved. This mitigates downtime and keeps the team productive. I would communicate this decision clearly to the Bangalore team by acknowledging the situation's urgency, explaining the rationale behind the redirection, and ensuring they know the importance of their work on both the recommendation engine and the LMS integration.

TASK 3 - REFLECT

The biggest structural weakness revealed is the lack of a unified communication and governance structure across teams, leading to misalignment on priorities and requirements. To prevent this, the company would need to establish a more robust cross-functional communication framework, ensuring that all stakeholders can

contribute to key decisions and maintain a clear and shared understanding of goals.

EXTRA TASK – RATE

The reflexionbot provides a structured approach to problem-solving and highlights critical thinking effectively. However, it could improve by offering more concrete examples and potential risks involved in each situation to enhance decision-making quality. Overall, it guides the thought process effectively while encouraging deeper analysis.

Message the AI Coach...

